Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

1. Never share OTPs, passwords, or UPI PINs with anyone, even if they claim to be from a bank.
2. Do not approve unknown UPI collect requests—you only need to enter your PIN when sending money, not receiving it.
3. Verify links before clicking—avoid suspicious or shortened URLs sent via SMS, email, or social media.
4. Use strong, unique passwords for all accounts and update them regularly.
5. Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) wherever possible for extra security.
6. Avoid public Wi-Fi for financial transactions like banking or payments.
7. Install apps only from trusted sources like official app stores.
8. Regularly check bank statements and transaction history to spot unauthorized activity.
9. Keep your device updated with the latest security patches and antivirus software.
10. Be cautious of urgent or "too good to be true" offers—they are often scams.

Reporting Cybercrime

- Report online fraud at: https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Call the Cybercrime Helpline: 1930

Reflection (100–150 words)

While learning about cybercrime, what surprised me most was how simple tricks, like asking for a UPI PIN under the pretense of sending money, can lead to major financial loss. I had assumed that scams required advanced technical skills, but many rely on basic social engineering and human error. It was also alarming to realize how quickly money can be transferred and how difficult it is to recover once lost.

One habit I will definitely change is being more cautious with payment requests and links. I will always double-check before approving any transaction and avoid acting in haste, especially when a message creates urgency. Staying alert and informed seems to be the most effective defense against such frauds.